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November 23, 2025

Hiring Committee
Uber Technologies, Inc.
1515 3rd Street
San Francisco, CA 94158

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Economist / Research Scientist position at Uber Technologies, Inc. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households. These themes align directly with Uber's emphasis on rigorous econometric modeling, simulation, and data-driven insights to understand behavior in two-sided marketplaces, optimize platform design, and improve pricing and matching algorithms.

In my job-market paper, I calibrate a life-cycle heterogeneous-agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns—finding a hump-shaped relationship for returns and characterizing the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to: (i) frame research strategies and design modeling approaches; (ii) execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro-data sets; and (iii) translate results into clear, rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am particularly excited about Uber's commitment to applying experimental methods, causal inference, marketplace design, and large-scale econometric modeling to improve platform efficiency and user experience. My background in simulation-based modeling, structural estimation, and empirical validation positions me well to contribute to work on surge pricing dynamics, driver supply responses, labor market incentives, matching algorithms, and transportation economics. I am also motivated by the opportunity to collaborate with data scientists, engineers, and economists on research that shapes high-impact product and policy decisions across multiple global markets.

I believe I would be a strong fit at Uber because:

1. My expertise in modeling heterogeneous behavior and building simulation frameworks aligns with Uber's needs for analyzing driver, rider, and marketplace dynamics.

2. My empirical research experience prepares me for causal inference, A/B testing, demand modeling, and experimentation at scale.
3. I bring strong communication skills and collaborative experience essential for working across interdisciplinary teams and delivering insights that influence product and policy decisions.

I am open to all Uber office locations included in the JOE listing, with particular interest in *San Francisco, Seattle, New York*. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my modeling, empirical, and analytical expertise to Uber's Economics and Research teams. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards